



Google launches Plus Codes

It is now easier to share details of a location even if users do not have a street address. <https://digit.in/jun20-106>



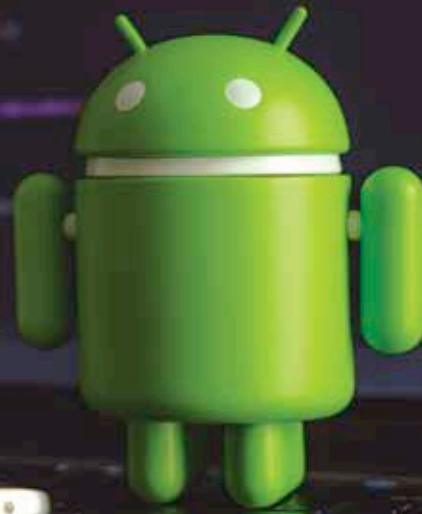
How Android became perfect

What makes Android so great is that it has roots in the OSs of both Blackberry and Apple. <https://digit.in/jun20-107>

Explore the Android file system

Explore the Android file system structure and layout

Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in



Credit: quietbits / Shutterstock.com

M

ost people know that the file system structure of Android devices shares some obvious similarities

with Linux since it is a framework that is built on top of Linux kernel. However, the Android file system structure does have some traits which are unique. Nevertheless, the thing that is common between them is that it lacks the concept of drives or directories as you see in Windows. Instead it uses partitions in a single directory, sort of like a single tree with multiple branches. Certain partitions of the file system can be leveraged by using file managers which lets you bring some semblance of order to your files. This is especially useful since sometimes it can feel that Android completely ignores conventional file storage practices, with users often ending up with a massive jumbled mess of files. Additionally, each partition has a certain function as well. So, let's delve into exploring the Android file system hierarchy in depth.

UNDERSTANDING ANDROID FILE SYSTEM PARTITIONS

Under the Android file system, there are usually six main partitions found on every device. Some devices may come with a couple of additional partitions, those differ from model to model, but there are six primary partitions which are found on every single Android device. These include /boot, /system, /recovery, /data, /cache and /misc. Additionally, for external SD cards which you may have in your Android smartphone, there are two file system partitions - /sdcard, /sd-ext. So, let's break down each partition separately to find out what it comprises.

- **/boot** – This partition consists of the Android kernel and the ramdisk. Basically, every single thing that is needed to boot your Android device when powered on. You should only proceed to wipe this partition from recovery if it is absolutely necessary. If you do, once the partition is wiped ensure to reboot the phone ONLY after installing a new boot partition. The new partition can be a /boot partition found in a ROM.

- **/system** – The system partition accommodates the entire Android OS. This includes the Android GUI as well as the system apps that come pre-installed on Android devices. So, what happens if you wipe this partition? Well, you can still boot the device, however, Android will be wiped so you will only be able to put your device into recovery or bootloader mode.

- **/recovery** – This partition is designed for backup and can be considered the alternative boot option or partition in an Android device. It lets the device boot into recovery mode where you can perform functions such as backing up data, wiping data, restoring phone to factory settings, and performing other maintenance operations.

- **/data** – Also known as userdata partition, this partition consists of all of the user's data including contacts, settings, apps and messages. Wiping the data partition will lead to restoring your phone to factory settings having removed all of the apps, messages and user settings from the Android device.

- **/cache** – This partition stores all the frequently accessed app data and